

Ticket to the movies

Instead of a tray, this drive features a slot-in mechanism that can be easily used in the horizontal or vertical positions. Its digital servo mechanism, CAV technology and Dynamic Damping System (DDS) helps it withstand vibration and also helps minimise errors by improving stability and accuracy of the data read.

AOpen 1640 PRO DVD-ROM



SPECIFICATIONS:

Interface: IDE
Features: 16x DVD/40x CD-ROM drive; slot-in-mechanism; supports CD formats like CD/DVD, CD-R/RW, DVD-R/RW; incorporates DDS, an internal buffer of 512 KB, bundles PowerDVD 2.55
Benchmarks: SiSoft Sandra: 3235 sequential read, 865 random read, 102 ms average access time; 1900 in CD WinBench 99

verdict

A -

AOpen 1640 PRO DVD-ROM				
Performance	▲	▲	▲	▲
Build Quality	▲	▲	▲	▲
Value for Money	▲	▲	▲	▲
Features	▲	▲	▲	▲
OVERALL	▲	▲	▲	▲

+ Slot-in mechanism
 - Does not support DMA
Price: Rs 5,950
Contact: Yogi Comp
Phone: 022-8806582
Fax: 022-8806582
E-mail: shailz@yogicomp.com
Web site: www.yogicomp.com

A good bargain

A low-budget motherboard that also delivers quality performance. Supports both Slot1 or Socket 370 based processors, which makes it useful for upgrading your processor in the future. Its dual-inline memory module banks support up to 256 MB of memory. This is a disadvantage as there is no space for further upgradations.

Kranion KP2A693A Motherboard



SPECIFICATIONS:

Socket Type: Slot1 or Socket 370
Chipset: VIA693A
Features: Five PCI slots, one ISA slot, one AGP 4x slot and one AMR slot; support for both Slot1 or Socket 370 based processors
Benchmarks: 1480 in 3D Mark2001, 21.8 in Content Creation

verdict

B +

KRANION KP2A693A MOTHERBOARD				
Performance	▲	▲	▲	▲
Build Quality	▲	▲	▲	▲
Value for Money	▲	▲	▲	▲
Features	▲	▲	▲	▲
OVERALL	▲	▲	▲	▲

+ Dual socket motherboard
 - Only two memory banks for DIMM
Price: Rs 3,000
Contact: Cerebra Integrated Technologies
Phone: 080-3474934 **Fax:** 080-3755492
E-mail: cerebra.smt@cerebracomputers.com

Anything but dull

A new entrant in the Indian market, this brand has some very striking features and specifications. It excels in graphics and audio applications, which puts it in the serious gamer's sights. The company has a toll-free number for ordering any Dell product and also for solving after-sales problems.

Dell Dimension 4100



SPECIFICATIONS:

Features: 1 GHz P-III, 128 MB RAM, 20 GB HDD, nVidia GeForce2 GTS w/32 MB video-card, Intel i815 motherboard, Creative SoundBlaster Live! soundcard, Harman/Kardon speaker system
Benchmarks: 33.5 in Business Winstone 99, 29.3 in ZD Content Creation, 6579 in 3DMark 2000, 122.8 fps in Quake III

verdict

A -

Dell Dimension 4100				
Performance	▲	▲	▲	▲
Build Quality	▲	▲	▲	▲
Value for Money	▲	▲	▲	▲
Features	▲	▲	▲	▲
OVERALL	▲	▲	▲	▲

+ Fault indicators on the motherboard
 + Machine can be customised according to your need
Price: Rs 81,999 (configuration specific, local taxes extra)
Contact: Dell Computers
Phone: 1600338044 (toll free)
Web site: www.dell.com

Steady and stable

This board proved to be very stable during the tests. It has a highly identifiable gold-plated heat sink installed over the north bridge. The motherboard also features the capability of varying the bus speed and the processor core voltage in steps, which makes it easier to overclock.

A Open AX3S Pro Motherboard



SPECIFICATIONS:

Intel i815 chipset, 133 MHz bus speed
Socket Type: Socket 370
Features: Bundles with two software CDs, including the drivers for the main board and Norton Antivirus 6.0
Benchmarks: 2336 in 3DMark 2001; 125.9 fps in Quake III (normal mode) and 94 fps (high quality); crunched through all 21 filters in 116 seconds in the Photoshop test

verdict

A -

A Open AX3S Pro Motherboard				
Performance	▲	▲	▲	▲
Build Quality	▲	▲	▲	▲
Value for Money	▲	▲	▲	▲
Features	▲	▲	▲	▲
OVERALL	▲	▲	▲	▲

+ Good facilities for over-clocking
 + Good package with detailed manuals
Price: Rs 7,000
Contact: Yogi Comp
Phone: 022-8806582
Fax: 022-8806582
E-mail: shailz@yogicomp.com
Web site: www.yogicomp.com